TITLE PAGE

Project Report

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Introduction

I’m currently serving as a Student Digital Ambassador at my college, which basically means I’m the go-to person for helping my peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally. This project serves as a comprehensive portfolio of my recent work, pulling together various skills I’ve been sharpening over the past few months. I decided to focus on five core areas that I think are essential for any student today: creating visual guides, building a professional online presence, getting hands-on with coding, mastering email communication, and understanding the risks of cybercrime. To keep everything organized and accessible, I’ve hosted the entire collection in a GitHub repository. It’s a great way to show, rather than just tell, what I’ve been up to. My goal was to create a resource that isn't just a list of tasks, but a reflection of how I’m growing as a professional in a tech-driven environment.

Task 1 Write-up: Infographic

For my first big task, I put together a one-page visual guide centered on digital literacy. I chose Canva for the design work because, honestly, their library of free templates is a lifesaver when you aren't a pro designer. My infographic breaks down the core meaning of digital literacy, highlights a few essential tools for students, and offers some quick tips on staying safe online. It sounds simple, but the process was a bit of a balancing act. I realized halfway through that I had way too much text. The hardest part was definitely the "kill your darlings" phase—trimming down my notes so the page didn't look like a cluttered mess. I wanted it to be something a student could glance at for thirty seconds and actually walk away with useful info. It’s a lot harder to be concise than it is to be wordy, but I'm really happy with how the final layout turned out.

Task 2 Write-up: Digital Portfolio

This task was all about setting up my “digital storefront.” I spent time polishing my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank to make sure they actually look professional to anyone stumbling across them. I see GitHub as my workbench where I’ll store all my actual code, while LinkedIn is more like the office lobby where I can meet people in the industry and keep tabs on job openings. HackerRank is where I go to keep my technical skills sharp. Looking ahead at the next four years, I have a clear plan. I want to use LinkedIn primarily to hunt for internships and build a network before I even graduate. Meanwhile, GitHub will be my living resume where future bosses can see the evolution of my class projects. I’m committed to keeping these updated; there’s nothing worse than a professional profile that looks like a ghost town.

Task 3 Write-up: Platforms

To get some practical experience with different web tools, I dove into HackerRank and Google Forms. On the coding side, I tackled the 'Solve Me First' challenge on HackerRank. It's a basic task, sure, but it's great for getting into the right headspace for logical problem-solving. It's like a warm-up for the brain. Then, I switched gears and built a 5-question quiz using Google Forms to test what my friends actually know about digital literacy. It turns out most of us know the basics, but there are some big gaps when it comes to privacy settings. These platforms are incredibly useful for my day-to-day studies. Coding sites help me think through problems more clearly, and Google Forms is a total game-changer for group projects when we need to gather data quickly. It's all about using the right tool for the job.

Task 4 Write-up: Email Etiquette

I spent some time drafting two very different, but equally important, emails. The first was a request to a professor for a deadline extension—always a nerve-wracking thing to write—and the second was an inquiry to a company about a summer internship. The biggest takeaway for me was just how much a clear subject line matters. If you don't nail that, your email might not even get opened. I also did some reading on the side and found a story about a student who missed out on a great job just because their email to the boss was way too casual. It really drove home the point that your tone is your digital first impression. It's not just about being polite; it's about showing that you respect the other person's time and professional standing. It's a small skill that makes a massive difference.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime

Doing research for this section was a real eye-opener, and frankly, a bit scary. I was shocked to see how rampant UPI fraud has become in India lately. It's wild how quickly someone can drain your bank account just by tricking you into clicking a suspicious link or scanning a random QR code. These scammers are getting incredibly good at looking legitimate. After reading through a bunch of case studies, I've decided to change my own digital habits immediately. I've gone ahead and turned on two-factor authentication for every single account I own. I've also made a personal rule: I will never share my UPI PIN with anyone, no matter who they claim to be. Even if someone calls saying they're from the bank or "technical support," I'm hanging up. It's just not worth the risk of losing everything in a few seconds.

Conclusion

Wrapping up this project has really helped me understand what being a "Digital Ambassador" actually looks like in practice. It’s not just a fancy title; it’s about having a solid handle on the tools we use every day. I feel so much more confident now when it comes to managing my GitHub, communicating in a professional way, and spotting red flags from hackers. These aren't just "school skills" either—they’re things I know I’m going to use every single day throughout college and once I start my actual career. It’s been a really grounded, practical way to learn how to navigate the digital world without getting lost or overwhelmed. I’m excited to keep building on this foundation as I move forward, and I feel ready to help others do the same as I continue my role at the college.

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